

Miners Face ACC For Two

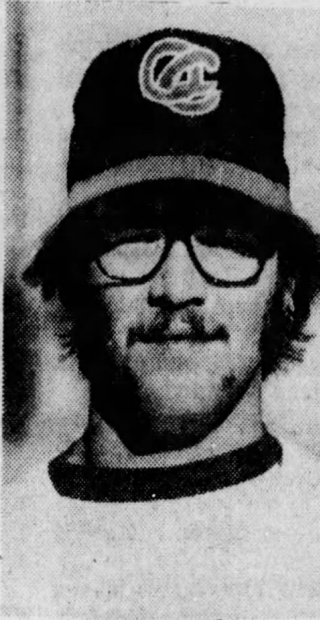
With six of the starting positions filled with returning lettermen, University of Texas at El Paso baseball coach Andy Cohen is set to start his, and the school's, 14th collegiate baseball season.

The Miners host Abilene Christian College for a three-game set with a doubleheader Friday and single game Saturday. Starting time is 1 p.m. both days at the Ysleta Cutoff Field.

Cohen expects to start Friday's game with six veterans in the starting lineup. Returnees Keith Rushing, Steve Dau and Terry Dillingham are slated to start in the outfield with Glenn Villareal at their, Dave Patt at short and Art Bravo at second. Dillingham logged most of his playing time last year as a first baseman, but spent some time in the outfield.

The newcomers to the Miner lineup are first baseman Keith Dwinell, a junior college transfer from Hill Junior College in Hillsborough, Texas, and catcher Terry Goodro, a freshman from Creighton High School in Omaha, Neb.

Returning letterman Jeff



Mike Rima



Terry Goodro

Hogan, the Miners' leading pitcher last season, has been tabbed as the starter in the opening game with newcomer Mike Rima slated for duty in the nightcap today. Rima is a transfer from Inidan Hills Junior College in Centerville, Ia. Returnee Dave Japnusch

will get the nod for Saturday's single game. Cohen listed Jerry Walker, Bill Watts and Gary Kobatt, all freshmen, as the relievers for this weekend.

"This is one of the hardest working bunches I've ever worked with," said Cohen of the 1976 squad. "They have a

lot od dedication and their attitude is good."

Abilene Christian brings a squad that has already played eight games, dropping a narrow 4-3 decision to Hardin-Simmons Tuesday in their latest outing.

The Wildcats are paced by first baseman Reid Huffman, who has three homers, nine RBIs and is hitting .380 after the eight games. Third sacker Bill Whitaker is the second leading hitter at .330.

The Miners have been in action four times, all exhibition games against Ranger Junior College two weeks ago. UTEP split the two-day series, winning one each day. And even though its early, Cohen learned from the games.

"I think our pitching might be a little stronger than I though originally," he said. "I was impressed with our young pitchers and I think the returning guys have improved, especially Dave Janusch. But we also learned that we lack real good team speed."

Last season the Miners compiled an 18-26 overall mark and were 3-15 in the WAC Southern Division.

UTEP will be in action again next weekend, hosting Denver University in a Saturday doubleheader.

Baseball Owners Stay Mum